

Document	FIN-03 Travel & Expenses Policy
Version	3 (replaces version 2)
Effective	1 March 2026
Owner	Finance Director
Status	Current

Travel & Expenses Policy

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out what Tallowby Freight Ltd will pay back when you spend your own money on company business, and how to claim it. The principle is straightforward: you should not be out of pocket for doing your job, and the company should not pay for anything that is really a personal cost. Spend company money as carefully as you would spend your own.

1.1 Who this applies to

The policy applies to all employees and to agency staff who have been told in writing by their manager that they may claim expenses. It covers travel away from your normal place of work, overnight stays, meals while travelling and the use of your own vehicle on company business. It does not cover the night-out allowance for HGV drivers, which is paid through payroll under the terms of the driver's contract (see 4.3).

1.2 What changed in this version

Version 3 replaces version 2 from 1 March 2026. Any expense incurred on or after that date is claimed under this version, even if the trip was booked earlier. The main changes are:

- new nightly hotel limits;
- higher meal allowances;
- a higher mileage rate for business journeys in your own car;
- a shorter deadline for submitting claims;
- receipts now needed for smaller amounts;
- new approval limits for line managers and department heads.

2. Before you travel

2.1 Getting approval

Any trip that involves an overnight stay, or travel outside England, must be approved in advance by your line manager using form EXP-1. Send the approved form to the Finance travel desk at travel@tallowby.example at least 5 working days before you travel, unless the trip is urgent. Day trips within England do not need an EXP-1, but you should still let your manager know where you are going.

2.2 Booking travel

Rail tickets and hotels should be booked through the Finance travel desk wherever possible, so the company pays directly and you do not have to claim the money back. Rail travel is standard class. First class is only allowed if it is cheaper than standard on the day, and you must keep proof of the fare comparison. Flights within the UK are only allowed where the same journey would take more than 4 hours by rail, and they need approval from the Finance Director as well as your line manager.

3. Hotels

3.1 Nightly limits

The limits below are the most the company will pay for one night, including breakfast and VAT. They are maximums, not targets: if a suitable hotel is available for less, book it.

Location	Limit per night (room and breakfast)
London (inside the M25)	£160
Birmingham, Bristol, Manchester, Edinburgh and Glasgow	£115
Anywhere else in the UK	£95
Outside the UK	agreed in advance with the Finance Director on form EXP-1

3.2 Going over the limit

Sometimes a cheaper room is simply not available, for example during a large event. In that case the travel desk can approve a higher rate before you book. If you book yourself and pay more than the limit without that approval, you will only be paid back up to the limit. Upgrades to a better room are always a personal cost.

3.3 Staying with friends or family

If you stay with friends or relatives instead of a hotel, you can claim a flat £25 per night to cover a thank-you gift or a meal for your hosts. No receipt is needed for this amount, but you must give the address on the claim.

4. Meals and subsistence

4.1 Day trips

When you work away from your normal workplace for part of a day, you can claim the actual cost of food and soft drinks, up to these limits:

- away for more than 5 hours: up to £10;
- away for more than 10 hours: up to £20 in total.

The time is counted from when you leave home or your normal workplace, whichever is later, to when you get back. You cannot claim for meals eaten at your own depot or office.

4.2 Overnight stays

When you stay away overnight, breakfast is included in the hotel limit. You can claim up to £30 for your evening meal, including soft drinks and service, and the day trip limits in 4.1 apply to lunch.

Unused amounts cannot be carried from one day to the next.

4.3 Drivers on nights out

HGV drivers who sleep in their cab on a planned night out receive the night-out allowance through payroll. They should not claim meals under this section for the same night. A driver who is sent to a hotel because the cab cannot be used, for example after a breakdown, follows sections 3 and 4.2 in the usual way.

5. Using your own vehicle

5.1 Mileage rates

If you use your own car or van for company business, you can claim a mileage allowance instead of the actual cost of fuel. The rate covers fuel, wear and tear and insurance, so you cannot also claim for petrol or diesel receipts.

- 45p per mile for the first 10,000 business miles in a tax year;
- 25p per mile after that;
- 24p per mile for a motorcycle.

Record each journey on form EXP-3 with the date, start point, destination, reason and miles.

5.2 What counts as business mileage

Your normal journey between home and your usual place of work is commuting and cannot be claimed. If you travel from home straight to another site, you can claim the extra miles over your normal commute. For example, if you normally drive 10 miles to the Leeds depot and instead drive 45 miles to the Hull depot, you can claim 35 miles.

5.3 Insurance and passengers

Before you use your own vehicle for work, your insurance must include business use. The company does not pay for this cover and will not pay any excess if you have an accident. You can add 5p per mile for each colleague you carry on the same business journey.

5.4 Parking, tolls and charges

Parking charges, bridge and road tolls and clean air zone charges paid during a business journey can be claimed with a receipt or payment record. Parking and traffic fines are never paid back (see section 8).

6. Making a claim

6.1 Deadlines

Submit your claim on form EXP-2 in StaffPoint within 30 days of the date you spent the money. Claims submitted more than 30 days late need a short written explanation from your line manager. Claims for expenses more than 90 days old will not be paid.

6.2 Receipts

You must attach an itemised receipt for any single expense over £10. A card slip showing only the total is not enough. Photos of receipts taken on your phone are fine, but keep the originals until the

claim has been paid. If you lose a receipt, complete a lost receipt declaration on form EXP-4. You can use EXP-4 no more than twice in a calendar year.

6.3 When you get paid

Claims approved by the 20th of the month are paid with that month's salary. Claims approved after the 20th are paid the following month. The Finance team checks a sample of claims every month and may ask you for more detail.

7. Approval

7.1 Approval limits

Every claim must be approved by someone other than the person claiming. The approval needed depends on the total value of the claim:

- up to £500: your line manager;
- over £500 and up to £2,000: your line manager and then your department head;
- over £2,000: as above, and then the Finance Director.

Nobody may approve their own claim or a claim from someone who approves theirs. Directors' claims are approved by the Finance Director, and the Finance Director's claims by the Managing Director.

7.2 Company payment cards

A small number of staff hold a company payment card. The same limits and rules apply to card spending. Card holders must upload receipts against each transaction by the 5th of the following month. Personal spending on a company card is not allowed, even if you intend to pay it back.

8. Things we do not pay for

8.1 Costs that are not reimbursed

The company will not pay for:

- alcohol;
- parking fines, speeding fines and any other penalty;
- films, minibar items or other personal extras in a hotel;
- room or seat upgrades;
- laundry, unless the trip lasts more than 5 nights in a row;
- lost or stolen personal belongings;
- childcare or pet care while you are away;
- costs of a partner or friend who travels with you.

8.2 Misuse of expenses

Claiming for something you did not spend, claiming twice for the same cost or altering a receipt will be treated as gross misconduct under the disciplinary procedure in HR-01. If you make a genuine mistake, tell Finance at expenses@tallowby.example as soon as you notice and it will simply be corrected.